

Henry Ford Health

Henry Ford Health Scholarly Commons

2025 Nursing Research Conference

Nursing Research Conference

9-30-2025

Improving RN–NA Collaboration and Communication: A Structured Approach to Enhance Patient Outcomes on Medical-Surgical Units

Rana Chehab

Henry Ford Health, rchehab1@hfhs.org

Godfrey A. Ogholo

Henry Ford Health, gogholo1@hfhs.org

Follow this and additional works at: <https://scholarlycommons.henryford.com/nursresconf2025>

Recommended Citation

Chehab, Rana and Ogholo, Godfrey A., "Improving RN–NA Collaboration and Communication: A Structured Approach to Enhance Patient Outcomes on Medical-Surgical Units" (2025). *2025 Nursing Research Conference*. 17.

<https://scholarlycommons.henryford.com/nursresconf2025/17>

This Poster is brought to you for free and open access by the Nursing Research Conference at Henry Ford Health Scholarly Commons. It has been accepted for inclusion in 2025 Nursing Research Conference by an authorized administrator of Henry Ford Health Scholarly Commons.

Introduction

Effective collaboration in communication and teamwork between Registered Nurses (RNs) and Nursing Assistants (NAs) are essential components of delivery high quality patient care (Kalisch and Lee, 2011). Inadequate collaboration can lead to delays, misunderstandings, and negative outcomes. It is essential to explore the perceptions and expectations of the RNs and NAs, as these factors may affect the quality of their interaction and communication, ultimately influencing the standard of care provided to patients

Method

An anonymous Likert type scale survey was designed for both RNs and the NAs, each comprising questions aimed at exploring perceptions that could enhance effective collaboration and teamwork. Find attached the QR code distributed between RNs and NAs encouraged to be completed and submitted

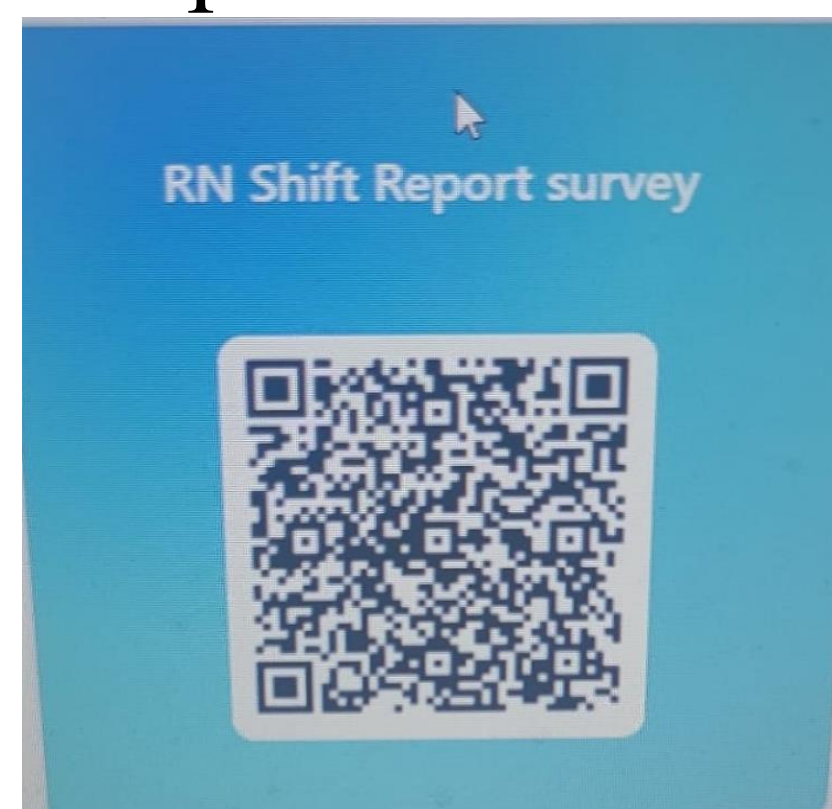


Figure. 1

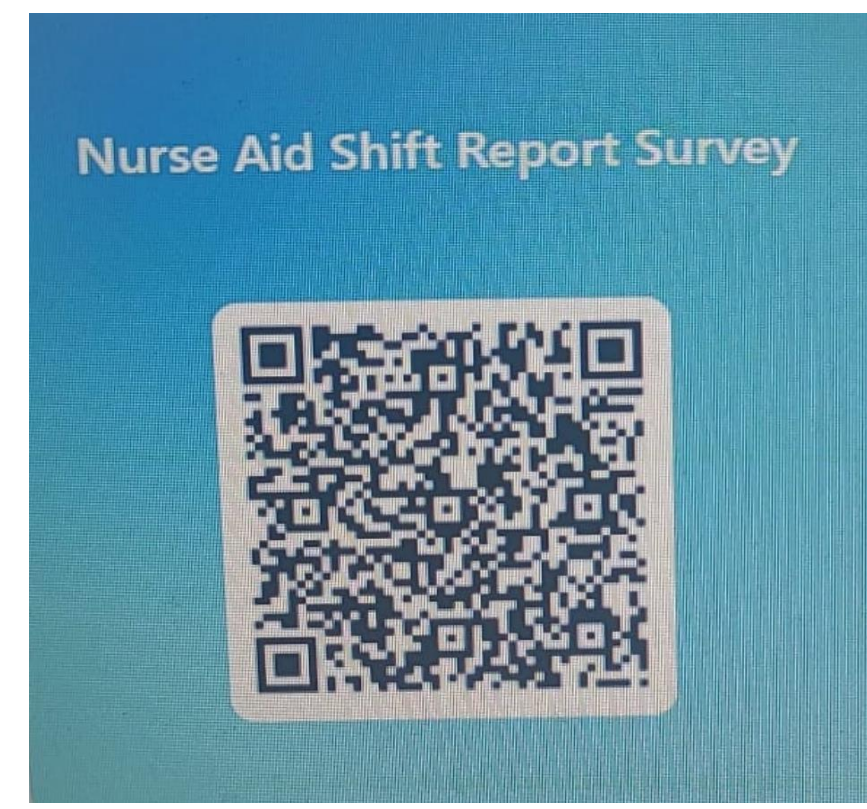


Figure. 2

Figure 1, QR code for the RNs Survey and Figure 2, QR code for the NAs survey

The Likert survey questions included perceptions of mutual respect, adequate shift reporting, frequency of communication, understanding expectations of task, confidence in timely completion of duties, role clarity, a supportive team

Results

According to completed and submitted survey questionnaire from RNs =47 and NAs =18 distributed in the 3rd, 5th and 6th floor clinical setting where relational quality and teamwork between RNs and NAs significantly changes the quality of patient care and satisfaction..

The responses obtained from the RNs and NAs were systematically organized, sorted, analyzed and extrapolated to present the following data:

- 94% NAs frequently communicate with RNs on patients issues or concerns
- 94%% NAs comfortable approaching RNs
- 44% NAs felt RNs consistently responded appropriately to patient condition changes
- 91% RNs frequently communicate with NAs
- 22% RNs confident on NAs reporting patient condition changes
- 66% RNs agree NAs sometimes follow instruction and completes task.
- 100% RNs and NAs agrees improved communication enhances quality of patient care outcomes

Histogram on Survey result

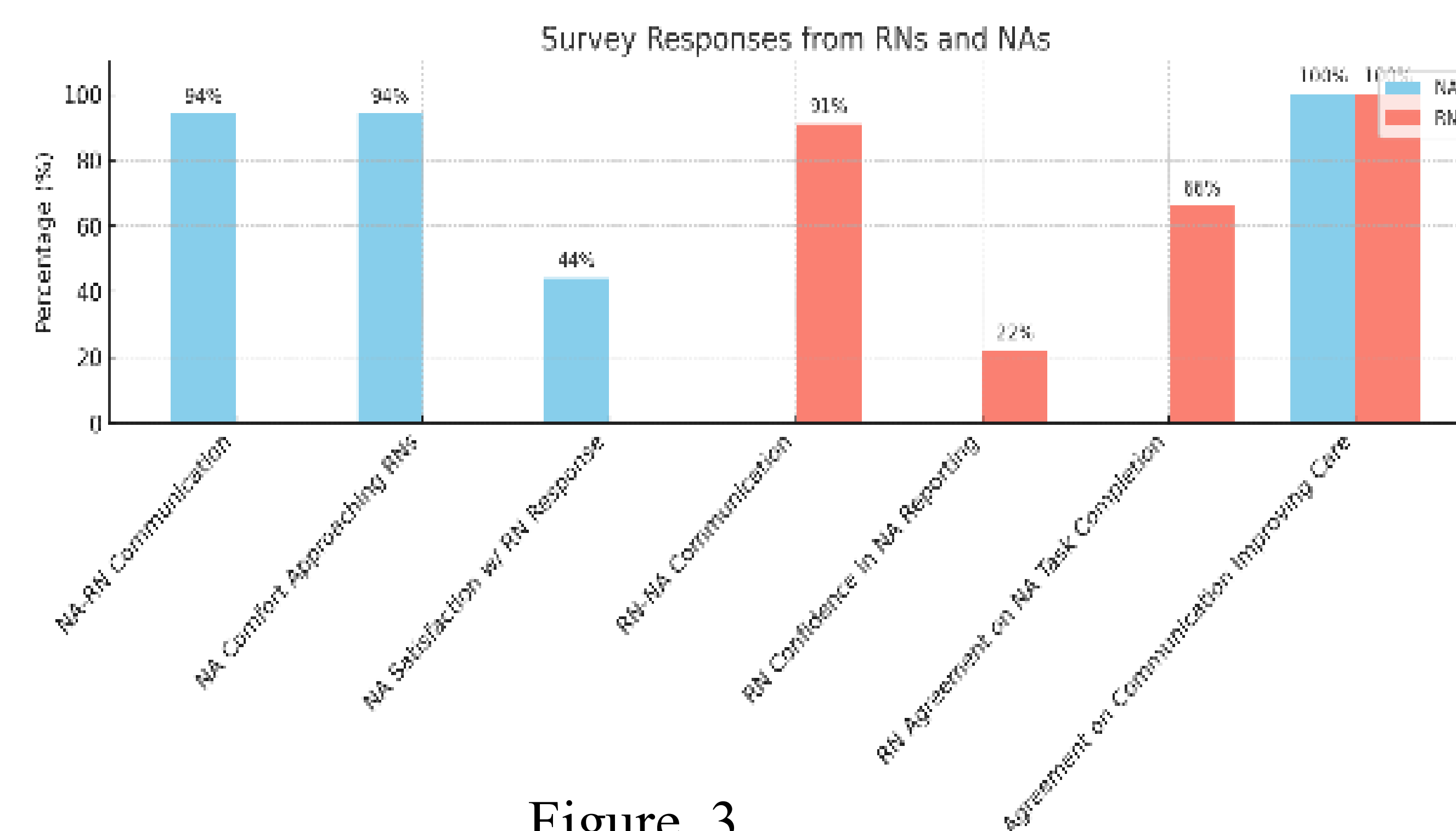


Figure 3

Figure 3: Histogram representation of the RN AND NAs survey

Discussion

RNs-NAs team wins when patients attest to receiving high quality of care during hospital stay - outcomes facilitated by



Figure 5



Figure 6

Figure 5: RN and NA Collaborating on patient care . Figure 6. Winning team celebrate

Effective communication and collaboration between RNs and NAs are formidable teamwork partners. However, the survey results showed that 94% of NAs agrees to frequent communication with RNs but only 44% of NAs agree that RNs consistently respond to changes in patient's condition. Similarly, only 22% of RNs are confident that NAs will report changes in patient's condition, and 66% of RNs sometimes agree that NAs will complete assigned task. These data reflect a suboptimal level of confidence in the working relationship between RNs and NAs that needs to improve to enhance the quality of patient care and satisfaction. Nonetheless, 100% of both RNs and NAs agrees improved communication promotes patients quality of care and inpatient satisfaction.

Conclusion

Campell et al, 2021 finds role clarity issues where NAs may not understand RNs expectation and the RNs inability to successfully lead the NAs creates barrier to teamwork and communication thus compromising relational quality that may affect safety outcomes. Also, understanding the message is a critical part of any communication hence RN-NA communication are encouraged to be transparent at best, respectful and honor the contribution of each member as valuable part of the team (Wagner 2018) . Some RNs describe teamwork as reminding NAs of necessary tasks to be completed and NAs perceive other NAs, rather than RNs as their team member who aid them in completion of their assigned task and such perception brews resentment that could lead to poor relational quality, low functioning team and ineffective collaboration (Campbell et al, 2021)

Given that patient care and satisfaction are shared objectives, it is imperative for RNs and Nas to engage with each other respectfully. This mutual respect is crucial for maintaining the relational quality and communication necessary to deliver high quality of service and ensure patient satisfaction.

Bibliography

- Campbell, Amy Richmond, et al.(2021) "Relational Quality between the RN and Nursing Assistant." JONA: The Journal of Nursing Administration, vol. 51, no. 9, Sept. 2021, pp. 461– 467,
- Kalisch, B. J., & Lee, K. H. (2011). Nurse staffing levels and teamwork: a cross-sectional study of patient care units in acute care hospitals. *Journal of nursing scholarship : an official publication of Sigma Theta Tau International Honor Society of Nursing*, 43(1), 82–88. <https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1547-5069.2010.01375.x>
- Wagner E. A. (2018). Improving Patient Care Outcomes Through Better Delegation-Communication Between Nurses and Assistive Personnel. *Journal of nursing care quality*, 33(2), 187–193.